organization. But the frontiers of space exploration today are increasingly going back from government organizations like NASA or ISRO into private hands, with firms such as Blue Origin or SpaceX. The reuse of rockets yields an 80 per cent cost saving, and this frontier is being pushed by private space exploration firms.

Engineers can often visualize simple designs, and are too quick to thrust their schemes upon society. As we have seen with USB chargers, there is a big gap between engineering and public policy. A recurring theme of this book is an appreciation of ‘self-organizing systems’, of the uncoordinated decisions of individuals left to themselves, that discover order by themselves. The organic development of the economic system, with freedom in the hands of each individual, works better than instructions from the top.

Even in the history of engineering, we see the weakness of state-led projects. There was once a rivalry between two standards in computer networking. A global club of governments developed and pushed a standard called X.25. An inchoate collection of academics and hobbyists developed an alternative standard called TCP/IP. The self-organizing system won, despite being backed by no state. The organic evolution of TCP/IP gave us the Internet, and X.25 died out. [2]

At the heart of the state is coercion

> *A state is a human community that (successfully) claims the monopoly of the legitimate use of physical force within a given territory.*
>
> Max Weber, The Vocation Lectures, 1919

While the state is often seen as benign or benevolent, almost like an uncle or a parent, we have to remember that at the heart of the state, there is violence. The state acquires a monopoly upon violence. States establish conditions where nobody is permitted to engage in violence, but the state is